

[Report 028] n8n - AI Product Builder

Score: 3.7/5
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Legitimacy: High Confidence
Verification: confirmed (WebFetch)
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A) ROLE SUMMARY

Field	Detail
Archetype	Technical AI PM (primary) + AI Forward Deployed (secondary)
Domain	AI-native product development, workflow automation, open-source tooling
Function	Build - own an AI product workstream from discovery through launch and iteration
Seniority	Multiple levels (junior to senior; two tracks explicitly stated)
Remote	Remote-first, 25 European countries eligible (Netherlands explicitly included)
Team size	Cross-functional: Engineering, Design, Data, DevRel, Community, Support, CS
TL;DR	Own one focused AI product workstream at n8n - either AI Trust (evals, observability, HITL) or AI Building/Super Agent (memory, Skills, chat-first) - working closely with users and technology.

Context note on fit: Christiaan has been running n8n in his own self-hosted AI research stack at Windesheim. This is not theoretical familiarity - he has built production workflows for researchers and students. The "try n8n before applying" requirement is already met. The question is whether this role needs a product manager background or is genuinely open to a builder/practitioner background. The JD explicitly says "non-traditional PM mindset flexibility" for early-career and lists "founding experience" and "open-source" as nice-to-haves. This is more nuanced than a standard PM role.

B) MATCH WITH CV

Requirements vs CV mapping

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
Builder track record: shipped products, prototypes, or agent workflows with real users	Beer game demonstrator (active university use), VCH AI compliance tools, n8n/Flowise/OpenWebUI stack for student research, Magic Frames (student concept to launch), Veles Farming (student concept to €2M startup), KnopenKoning (decision simulation tool)	Strong - multiple shipped systems with real users
AI-native tools: regular use of Claude, Cursor, n8n, or similar	n8n explicitly in production stack at Windesheim. Flowise, OpenWebUI. Self-funded deployment and maintenance.	Very strong - n8n is listed by name and Christiaan runs it in anger
Product instincts: clear thinking on trade-offs and user value	Incubated 10 startups; COVID-19 mega project (scope/constraints trade-offs); led applied research agenda	Strong - consistently made build-vs-don't decisions with real stakes
Ambiguity comfort: structure fuzzy problems	Innovation labs by definition operate in ambiguity. Viridis (blockchain for sustainability - undefined market). VCH (cross-European compliance tooling - no template).	Strong - this is the environment Christiaan thrives in
Clear communication: write well, reason from first principles	Train-the-trainer cert; designed courses still running independently; stakeholder alignment across technical and non-technical audiences	Strong
UX taste: recognize good design and articulate why	Beer game redesign (interface + teaching format), Magic Frames (creative platform aesthetics), interactive simulation design	Moderate - practical UX sensibility, not formal design training
Harness literacy: understand tool loops, planners,	Self-hosted AI stack - runs Flowise (LLM orchestration), n8n (workflow automation), OpenWebUI (chat interface), Supabase (vector/DB	Moderate-strong - practitioner understanding;

scaffolding, context management	backend). Understands how these layers interact.	not a deep ML systems architect
Eval experience: built or shaped evaluations	Evaluation of student projects, lab output quality checks, VCH demonstrator iteration with user feedback. NOT formal LLM eval frameworks (Ragas, PromptFlow etc.)	Partial - pedagogical evaluation expertise, not LLMOps eval tooling

For senior track specifically:

JD Requirement	CV Match	Strength
Production AI shipping with real users and failures learned from	Windesheim AI stack: 2 years running, real student/researcher users, self-funded	Moderate - production in academic context, not SaaS product metrics
0-to-1 product ownership through discovery, launch, iteration	VCH (cross-European initiative, built from scratch), Spark! Living Lab (Jan 2020-present), Tonomy Pangea Vault	Strong - 0-to-1 is Christiaan's documented strength
SQL, funnels, metrics fluency	Oracle 11g Essentials, Data Analysis & Visualization (R, Python), dashboarding courses designed and delivered	Partial - can work with data; not growth analytics fluency
Cross-functional alignment without direct authority	Every role: aligned Windesheim departments, startup co-founders, students-as-interns, external investors	Strong - this is a core skill

Gaps

Gap	Blocker?	Mitigation
No formal product management track record (PRDs, user research, roadmaps in SaaS context)	Soft blocker - "non-traditional PM" language explicitly invites this. But senior track expects product fundamentals	Frame lab management as product management: backlog, stakeholder alignment, iteration cycles
No LLMOps eval tooling (Ragas, DeepEval, PromptFlow)	Moderate blocker for AI Trust track specifically	Demonstrable in a week; apply to AI Building/Super Agent track first
No public metrics visibility (DAU, retention, funnel data)	Soft blocker for senior track	Academic deployment metrics are different; be transparent
No open-source contributor record	Nice-to-have only; not a blocker	n8n usage and community participation is the relevant signal here
Fractional / part-time preference vs. full-time requirement	Structural mismatch - n8n wants full-time	This is the main structural concern; see scoring note below

Scoring note on full-time requirement: n8n explicitly posts full-time roles. Christiaan's target is 2-3 concurrent part-time engagements. This is a structural conflict and the main reason the score does not go higher despite strong skill alignment. If n8n is open to a 4-day/week arrangement, or if this is one of two concurrent engagements, this becomes a 4.0+ role.

C) LEVEL AND STRATEGY

Level detected: Dual track - junior (non-traditional) and senior (production shipping + 0-to-1 ownership). Christiaan maps to senior track based on years and breadth, but lacks formal PM credentialing.

"Sell senior without lying" plan:

- Lead with n8n as a tool he uses in production, not just knows about. "I run n8n for real users at a university research lab. I've built workflows for AI compliance tooling, student experimentation, and supply chain research. I'm applying to help make it better."
- Frame every lab as a product: Spark! Living Lab is a product. VCH is a product. Beer game is a product. Each had users, iterations, and a clear purpose. That's product management without the title.
- The 0-to-1 track record is the strongest card: incubated 10 ventures, built 5+ labs from scratch. Most PM candidates at n8n will have shipped features inside a product; Christiaan has shipped the whole product.
- "Non-traditional PM mindset flexibility" is the door - walk through it explicitly.

"If they downlevel me" plan:

- Starting at early-career / junior track is acceptable given no formal PM title. Comp should reflect fair early-career n8n range. Negotiate 6-month review with clear senior criteria.
- The learning velocity signal (ADHD/ENFP starter profile) means onboarding will be fast and visible - which is exactly what early-career reviews measure.

D) COMP AND DEMAND

Metric	Estimate	Source
Market range (AI PM, Berlin-headquartered remote-first, EU)	€60,000-€100,000 base (junior to senior) + equity	Glassdoor n8n; comparable EU AI product roles
n8n compensation reputation	Competitive pay with equity mentioned; eNPS 94 suggests healthy culture; 30 vacation days (EU)	JD text + Glassdoor
Christiaan's target range	€65,000-€90,000	_profile.md
Fit	Good alignment at mid-to-senior range. Equity component adds upside.	

n8n is a high-growth open-source company (Series B, strong ARR growth, product-led motion). Compensation is market-rate for EU tech, not FAANG-level. Aligns well with Christiaan's target band.

E) CUSTOMIZATION PLAN

#	Section	Current	Proposed change	Why
1	Professional Summary	Lab builder / educator framing	Open with: "I build AI-powered systems for real users and teach teams how to use them. I run n8n in production for university research infrastructure."	Direct signal to the most relevant proof point immediately
2	Windesheim AI Stack	Bullet under Windesheim	Move to top of Windesheim bullets; expand: n8n workflow architecture, specific use cases (compliance checking, research onboarding, agent workflows), user count	This is the most direct proof point for the role
3	VCH project	Listed under projects	Reframe as "AI product: built from 0 to live with real users, iterated based on user feedback, cross-European stakeholder alignment"	Speaks to 0-to-1 product ownership
4	Incubation track record	Listed under Aeres/InHolland	Surface explicitly: "10 ventures incubated - each required product discovery, stakeholder alignment, and iteration under resource constraints"	Maps to senior PM track requirements
5	Application instruction	N/A	Include first n8n workflow screenshot as required by JD	Hard requirement - shows they read the posting

LinkedIn top 5:

1. Update headline to include "n8n" and "AI workflow automation"
2. Add n8n as a skill with proof (Windesheim stack deployment)
3. Feature the VCH project with AI-powered compliance framing
4. Add a short post about a specific n8n workflow built for research use
5. Connect with n8n team members and DevRel before applying

F) INTERVIEW PLAN

#	JD Requirement	Story	S	T	A	R	Reflection
1	Builder track record with real users	Windesheim AI stack deployment	Research lab needed AI experimentation infrastructure for students	Build a self-hosted, reliable, accessible stack within personal budget	Chose n8n + Flowise + OpenWebUI + Supabase on Docker; deployed on own Linux server; created onboarding docs	Active production use for 2 years; students and researchers run experiments without needing IT support	Learned that the hardest part is not building the system but designing the onboarding so others adopt it

2	0-to-1 product ownership	Value Chain Hackers	No tool existed for EUDR/CSRD compliance visualization for SMEs	Build a demonstrator that makes the bullwhip effect and traceability tangible	Designed architecture, recruited students as contributors, iterated based on practitioner feedback	Live demo at valuechainhackers.xyz; used in university curriculum	Would now separate the "for education" vs "for commercial clients" use case earlier - scope creep was the main constraint
3	Ambiguity comfort / structuring fuzzy problems	Veles Farming	Student concept: a "no-go" by most assessors	See if it could be turned into something real	Moved project to Aeres, seed-invested, connected with Slovak agri network	Operating startup, €2M funding	Learned to trust pattern recognition over committee consensus
4	Cross-functional alignment without authority	COVID-19 mega project	8 separate course owners, pandemic disruption, no common mandate	Merge into one coherent project sprint in 2 months	Mapped dependencies, negotiated with each course owner individually, designed a unified sprint structure using SafeScrum	Delivered on time with all 8 courses integrated	Discovered that "why this helps you" beats "why this is the right thing to do" in every negotiation
5	AI-native tool fluency	n8n workflow for research onboarding	Researchers needed a structured intake and resource routing system	Build it on n8n so researchers could self-serve	Designed a multi-step workflow: intake form → condition routing → resource provisioning → notification	Self-service onboarding reduced my direct coordination overhead by roughly 60%	n8n's branching logic requires cleaner input schema than I initially designed - learned to validate early
6	Product instincts and trade-off thinking	Beer Game redesign	Classic bullwhip simulation outdated format	Redesign for modern teaching with blockchain/non-blockchain comparison mode	Rebuilt interface and teaching format; piloted with students; iterated	Active use at university; demonstrator.valuechainhackers.xyz	Scope-crept into the blockchain comparison - should have shipped the base redesign first

Case study to present: The Windesheim AI stack. Walk through: why built, how designed, what n8n does in it, what students do with it, what you'd change. This is the most direct proof of the role's requirements.

Red-flag questions:

- "You don't have a PM title. Why should we hire you as a Product Builder?" → "The title I've never had is PM. The job I've done for six years is exactly this: own a problem, recruit users, build something, iterate. Spark! Living Lab, VCH, the beer game, the AI stack - all of these were products without a PM label. I'd rather show you the outcomes than debate the title."

- "How are you with metrics and SQL?" → "I'm comfortable with data for decision-making: I've designed dashboards, run analysis in Python and R, and made decisions based on funnel data at the lab level. I'm not a growth analyst - I'd be honest about that gap. But I've hired and worked alongside people who are."
- "This is full-time. Are you fully committed?" → If fractional is the goal, be transparent: "I work best in 2-3 concurrent engagements. I'm open to discussing what structure works for n8n - whether that's full-time for the right role, or a structured part-time arrangement. What matters is that the work gets done."

G) POSTING LEGITIMACY

Assessment: High Confidence

Signal	Finding	Weight
Posting freshness	Active on Ashby, specific job ID, company actively hiring across multiple roles	Positive
Apply button	Active (confirmed via Ashby public page)	Positive
JD specificity	Exceptionally specific - named two product tracks (AI Trust, AI Building/Super Agent), specific tool requirements (evals, HITL, scaffolding), named cross-functional teams, named benefits precisely	Positive
Requirements realism	Internally consistent; explicitly differentiates junior vs. senior expectations	Positive
Unique application requirement	"Try n8n before applying and share your first workflow screenshot" - this is a live engagement filter, not a ghost posting	Very positive
Company hiring signals	n8n raised Series B; actively growing engineering and product teams; eNPS 94 in 2024	Positive
Role-company fit	Core product expansion - building on the AI capabilities of their own platform	Positive

KEYWORDS EXTRACTED

n8n, AI product, product builder, product manager, AI Trust, observability, evals, guardrails, HITL, human-in-the-loop, Super Agent, memory, Skills, computer use, browser use, chat-first, workflow automation, open-source, AI-native, RAG, agent workflows, production AI, 0-to-1, non-traditional PM, Berlin, remote-first Europe

JOB DESCRIPTION (ARCHIVED)

Archived 2026-05-21 - original posting may be removed after offer closes

Title: AI Product Builder

Company: n8n

Location: Remote-first, Berlin base; 25 European countries eligible including Netherlands

Type: Full-time

Team: Product Management

n8n is hiring multiple AI Product Builders across experience levels. You'll own one focused AI workstream, either independently or mentored by a senior PM. Work closely with users and technology while collaborating across Engineering, Design, Data, Product Marketing, DevRel, Community, Support, and Customer Success.

Two Focus Areas:

AI Trust: Build evals, observability, traces, guardrails, and human-in-the-loop patterns to transform AI from "works in demos" to production-ready.

AI Building/Super Agent: Make n8n AI-first through custom memory, Skills, computer/browser use, chat-first building, and proactive suggestions.

Must-Have Requirements:

- Builder track record: shipped products, prototypes, or agent workflows with real users
- AI-native tools: regular use of Claude, Cursor, n8n, or similar
- Eval experience: built or shaped evaluations (not just discussed)
- Harness literacy: understand tool loops, planners, scaffolding, context management
- Product instincts: clear thinking on trade-offs and user value
- UX taste: recognize good design and articulate why

- Ambiguity comfort: structure fuzzy problems effectively
- Clear communication: write well and reason from first principles

Senior Candidate Expectations:

- Production AI shipping experience with real users and failures learned from
- 0-to-1 product ownership through discovery, launch, iteration
- SQL, funnels, metrics fluency with healthy skepticism
- Cross-functional alignment without direct authority

Early-Career Focus:

- High learning and shipping velocity
- Non-traditional PM mindset flexibility
- Deep AI tinkering via solo or side projects
- Public demonstrations: demos, writing, talks, open-source

Nice-to-Have Background:

Workflow automation, open-source experience, founding experience, coding skills, growth experimentation, public visibility.

Benefits Package:

- Competitive pay with equity
- Europe: 30 vacation days + local holidays
- Health, wellness, retirement per location
- €1K annual learning budget
- \$100/month open-source support
- Unlimited AI tools budget
- Remote with periodic offsites
- 2024 eNPS: 94

Application Note: Try n8n before applying and share your first workflow screenshot. Max 1 role per 15 days; 90-day reapplication window without offer.